The Guardian

one stop english

‘It’s a bit too castle-y’: plans to turn Cumbrian fortress into eco-attraction

Level 1: Elementary – Teacher’s notes

Article summary: The article describes a family’s work to turn their castle into a carbon-zero eco-friendly tourist destination.

Time: 60 minutes

Skills: Reading, Speaking, Writing

Language focus: Phrasal verbs

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. The purpose of this activity is to get students to think about travel and their preferences. All of these countries are considered top ecotourism destinations. Make sure learners give reasons for their choice of destination. This can be continued in the *In Your Own Words* activity, where they can use the same destination to complete the task.

2. Key words

a. Ask students to do the exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs or small groups. Students may be familiar with the word *single* to mean ‘one item’, but in the article, it means ‘someone who is not married or in a romantic relationship’.

Key:

1. *heat*
2. *castle*
3. *furniture*
4. *eco-friendly*
5. *single*
6. *hill*
7. *mountain*
8. *manage*
9. *earn*
10. *future*

b. Before reading the article carefully, students use some of the key words to fill the gaps in the sentences to ensure that they understand their meanings and usage. In item 1, the answer could be *hill,* but it is a more significant accomplishment to be the first person to climb a mountain than a hill.

Key:

1. *mountain*
2. *future*
3. *furniture*
4. *heat*

3. Comprehension check

a. The answers given are only suggested answers, and students may correctly answer the questions in different ways, e.g., in item 3, they may say ‘The castle is in the UK’ or similar.

Key:

1. *1990*
2. *800 years old*
3. *in the UK*
4. *make the castle eco-friendly*
5. *32 years old*
6. *San Francisco*
7. *two hours*
8. *his parents*
9. *hills and mountains*
10. *about £10,000*

4. Key language

a. Students could be asked to do this exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs. The words on the left are all used in the text. As an extension activity, ask students to find other words in the text they know opposites for, such as *before*, *old*, *go*, *cold* and *happy*.

Key:

1. *f*
2. *d*
3. *e*
4. *b*
5. *a*
6. *c*

5. Discussion

a. Allow students time to note down their ideas about each statement and encourage them to say why they agree or disagree with each one.

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6. In your own words

a. Have students use a search engine to find more information about eco-friendly tourist destinations. Ask them to find some top locations for holidays and what you can do in those places. Students could use one of the locations from the Warmer exercise if they wish.

b. Students could then present their reports to the class.

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